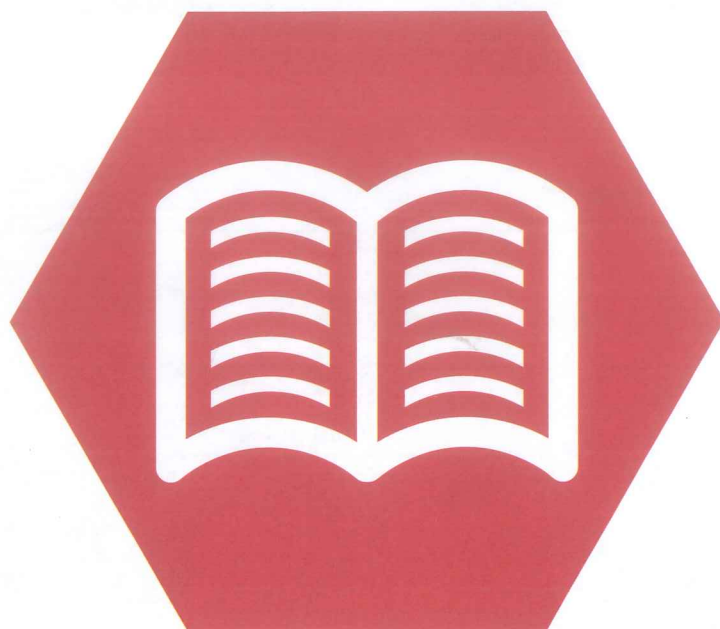




UNSW Global  
AUSTRALIA

# INTRODUCTORY PAPER



2015  
ICAS

International Competitions  
and Assessments for Schools

ENGLISH

Educational Assessment Australia  
[eaa.unsw.edu.au](http://eaa.unsw.edu.au)

**DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL INSTRUCTED.**

**35 QUESTIONS**

**TIME ALLOWED: 35 MINUTES**

**STUDENT'S NAME:**

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a 2B or B pencil.

Do **NOT** use a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.

Your score will be the number of correct answers.

Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **35 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–35).

Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.

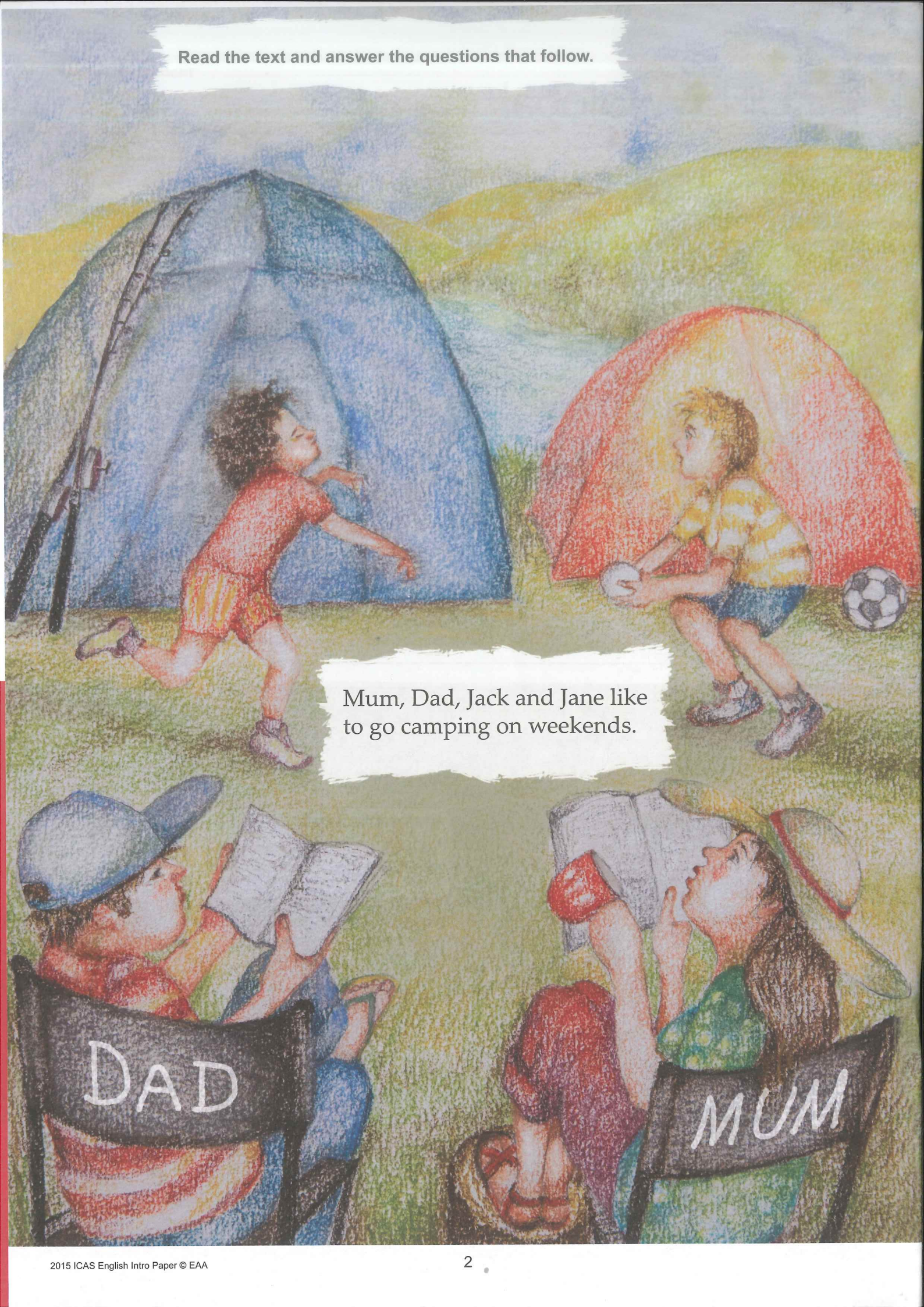
On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other.

Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.



Mum, Dad, Jack and Jane like to go camping on weekends.

1. What is Dad doing in the picture?
- (A) walking
  - (B) reading
  - (C) cooking
  - (D) sleeping
2. The picture shows the family camping near a
- (A) car.
  - (B) house.
  - (C) city.
  - (D) river.
3. Jack and Jane are playing with
- (A) a cat.
  - (B) a dog.
  - (C) a ball.
  - (D) a doll.
4. Look at the small picture on the right.
- This picture tells readers that the family
- (A) fly kites.
  - (B) go fishing.
  - (C) play tennis.
  - (D) take photographs.



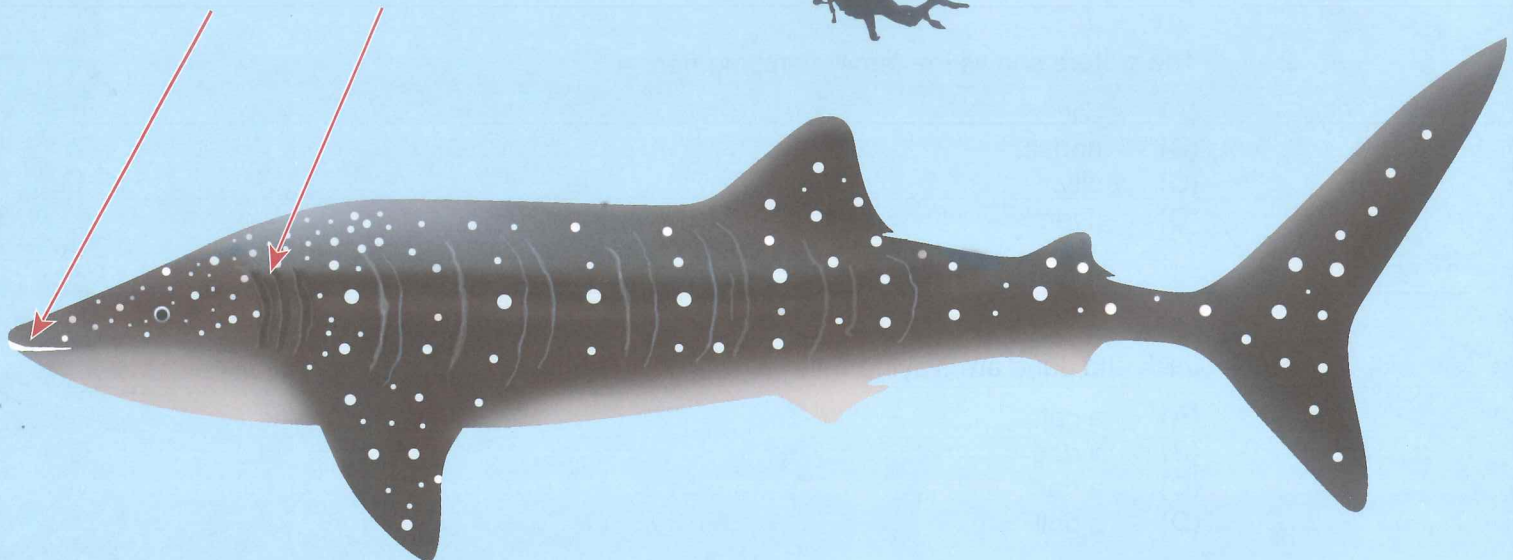
Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

# The world's **LARGEST** fish

Whale sharks are the world's largest fish. They are called whale sharks because they are so huge.

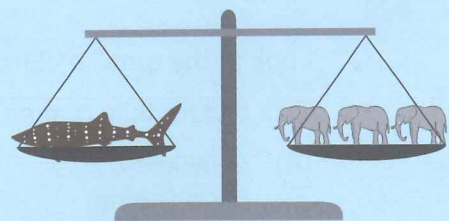
Unlike whales, whale sharks do not breathe in air. They breathe in water using their mouth and gills.

Swimming with whale sharks is an *amazing* experience.



Whale sharks mainly eat tiny plants and animals that live in the sea.

An adult whale shark can weigh the same as three adult elephants.



← Whale sharks can grow up to 20 metres. →

5. Why are whale sharks named after whales?

- (A) Both animals breathe in air.
- (B) Both animals are large.
- (C) Both animals are the same colour.
- (D) Both animals swim with people.

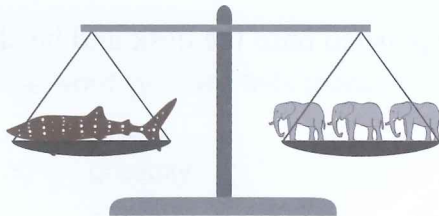
6. Whale sharks mainly eat

- (A) small whales.
- (B) small sharks and humans.
- (C) tiny plants and animals.
- (D) large fish.

7. The word '*amazing*' is written in *italics* to show that

- (A) it has special importance.
- (B) it is an adjective.
- (C) it is a common word.
- (D) it is a hard word to spell.

8.



This diagram mainly gives information about

- (A) the diet of whale sharks.
- (B) the shape of whale sharks.
- (C) the length of whale sharks.
- (D) the weight of whale sharks.

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

# The letter M

As usual Paul and Corey had left their homework until the last minute. Now they were in the library with only a short time to complete their work. Their teacher had asked the class to write about something interesting beginning with the letter M.

‘What starts with M?’ asked Paul, chewing loudly on bubble gum. He blew a bubble and Corey leaned over and popped it with a pen.

‘No chewing gum in the library,’ whispered a girl with blonde hair.

‘That’s Molly Martin.’ Corey nudged Paul. ‘Both her names start with the letter M.’

‘She can’t tell me what to do,’ muttered Paul. ‘M is for meddling.’

‘We can’t do a project on meddling. Think of something else starting with M.’

‘How about mashed potato?’ Paul laughed and reached down into his school bag. He took out a can of soft drink and opened the tab. Pshhsst!

Molly Martin raised an eyebrow and said, ‘No drinking in the library.’

Paul guzzled his drink. Some droplets splashed onto the desk and he slurped them up.

‘That’s disgusting,’ said Molly Martin.

‘M is for mind your own business,’ whispered Corey. He picked up his mobile phone and started playing a game. It made loud pops and clacks.

Suddenly a shadow loomed over Paul and Corey. It was Ms Beasley, the librarian.

‘Boys, I won’t have you breaking the rules in my library. I’ve a good mind to call your mothers. I won’t, though, if you both read this book and write a summary page each.’ Paul and Corey sat up straight. Ms Beasley placed the book on the table. It was called *M is for Manners*.

Paul and Corey moaned.

Molly Martin smiled.

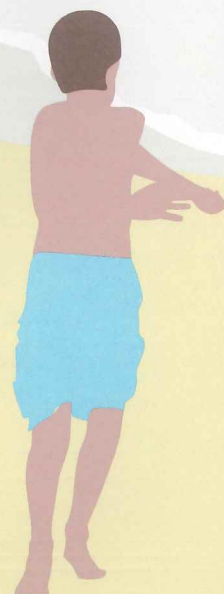
9. Why were Paul and Corey in the library?
- (A) to eat their lunch
  - (B) to speak with Ms Beasley
  - (C) to talk to Molly Martin
  - (D) to complete their homework
10. Which word from the second paragraph sounds like the action or thing that it describes?
- (A) 'chewing'
  - (B) 'blew'
  - (C) 'bubble'
  - (D) 'popped'
11. Why did Molly Martin whisper to Paul and Corey?
- (A) to tell them a secret
  - (B) to ask for bubble gum
  - (C) to remind them of the rules
  - (D) to help them with their project
12. Paul said 'M is for meddling' because he thought
- (A) Molly needed to mind her own business.
  - (B) Corey was being mean to him.
  - (C) it was a good topic for their project.
  - (D) the homework from the teacher was boring.
13. The word 'guzzled' tells readers that Paul drank his soft drink
- (A) slowly.
  - (B) greedily.
  - (C) carefully.
  - (D) quietly.
14. How did Paul and Corey feel at the end of the text?
- (A) relieved
  - (B) puzzled
  - (C) defeated
  - (D) convinced

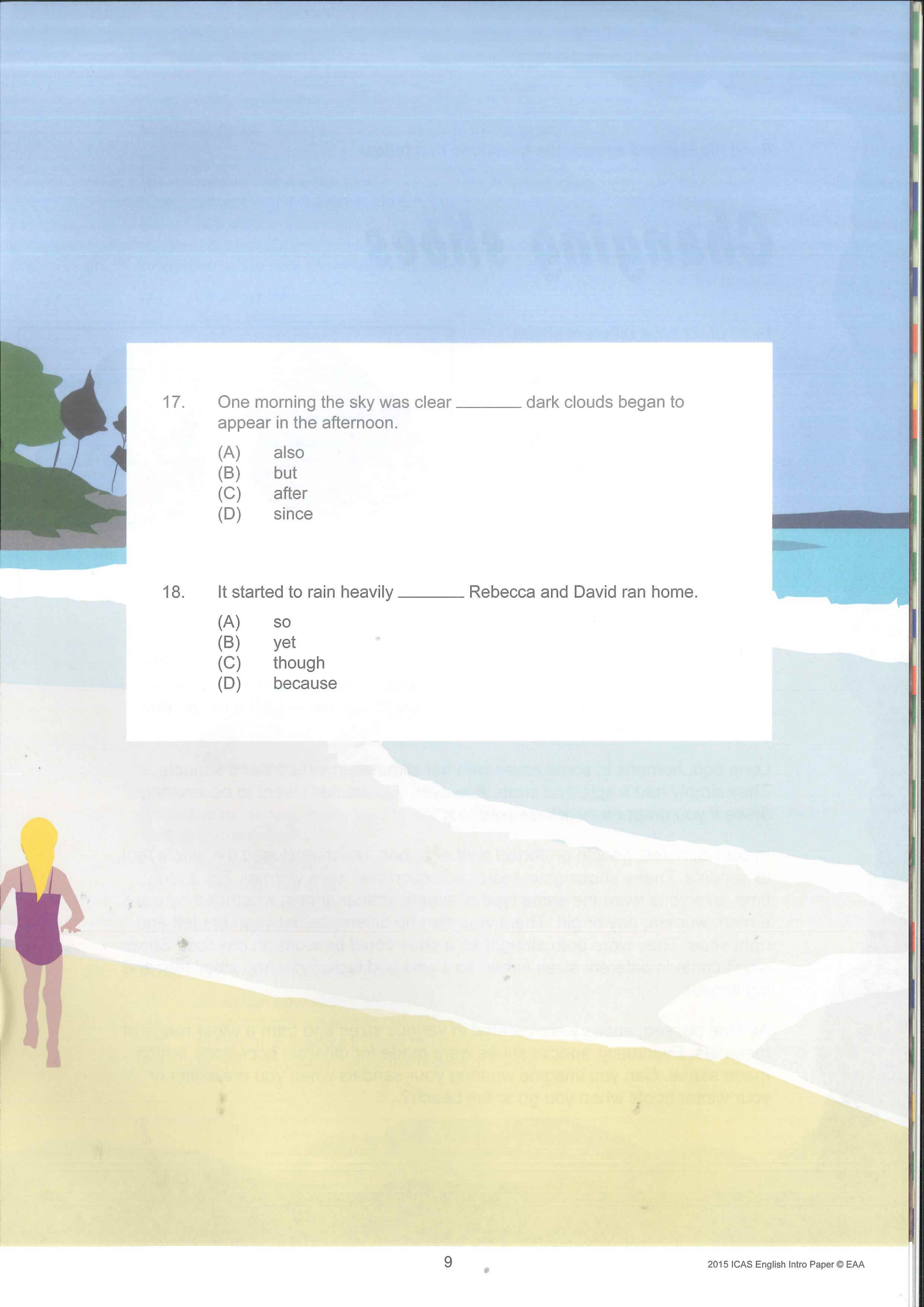


For each question, choose the option that best completes the sentence.

# THE BEACH HOLIDAY

15. During their last summer holidays, Rebecca and David \_\_\_\_\_ to walk on the beach.
- (A) like
  - (B) likes
  - (C) liked
  - (D) liking
16. However, they \_\_\_\_\_ go to the beach if the weather was bad.
- (A) would've
  - (B) weren't
  - (C) doesn't
  - (D) wouldn't





17. One morning the sky was clear \_\_\_\_\_ dark clouds began to appear in the afternoon.

- (A) also
- (B) but
- (C) after
- (D) since

18. It started to rain heavily \_\_\_\_\_ Rebecca and David ran home.

- (A) so
- (B) yet
- (C) though
- (D) because

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

# Changing shoes

Most of us have different shoes for school, sports and special occasions. In the past, people didn't have these choices.

Early humans spent a lot of time in bare feet. That's right, no shoes! Imagine what that must have been like when the ground was hot from the sun or freezing from the snow. Ouch!

Humans needed something to protect their feet. So, they came up with the idea of making shoes out of vines, straw and other parts of plants. These shoes didn't last very long or give much protection from rain or snow. It was clear that better materials were needed. They tried animal skins and found that these lasted longer and were softer.

Long ago, humans in some areas with hot climates invented basic sandals. They simply had a sole and strap. However, you wouldn't want to be wearing these if you dropped a rock on your foot.

In cold climates, people preferred leather shoes, which enclosed the whole foot, to sandals. These shoes gave more protection and were warmer. For a long time, everyone wore the same type of simple leather shoes, whether they were a man, woman, boy or girl. There was also no difference between the left and right shoe. They were both straight so a shoe could be worn on any foot. Shoes didn't come in different sizes either, so it was bad luck if you had small feet and big shoes!

As time passed, shoes were created in various sizes and from a wider range of materials. Eventually, special shoes were made for different occasions, which made sense. Can you imagine wearing your sandals when you are skiing or your winter boots when you go to the beach?



These 6000-year-old sandals from Spain are made from straw.

19. 'That's right, no shoes!'

In this sentence, the writer expects readers to agree with her and

- (A) be amazed.
- (B) realise that it is not true.
- (C) accept that it is a good idea.
- (D) feel sad.

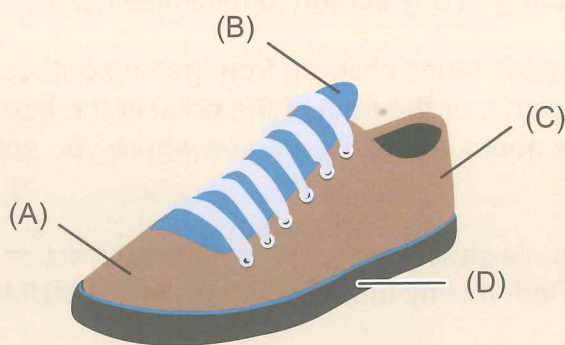
20. According to the text, shoes were invented so people could

- (A) decorate their feet.
- (B) live in cold places.
- (C) protect their feet.
- (D) move faster.

21. According to the text, shoes made from animal skins were better than those made from plants because

- (A) they cost less money to make.
- (B) they were soft and long-lasting.
- (C) they came in different colours.
- (D) they were easy to make and replace.

22. Which option shows the 'sole' of the shoe?



23. According to the text, how were the first leather shoes different from leather shoes today?

- (A) They were smaller.
- (B) They had one size.
- (C) They were tougher.
- (D) They had two straps.

24. What is the main purpose of this text?

- (A) to explain how shoes are made
- (B) to encourage readers to own lots of shoes
- (C) to convince readers to wear the right shoes
- (D) to give information about the history of shoes

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

# Video games are great

There is more to playing video games than some people realise. Children can learn valuable skills along the way.

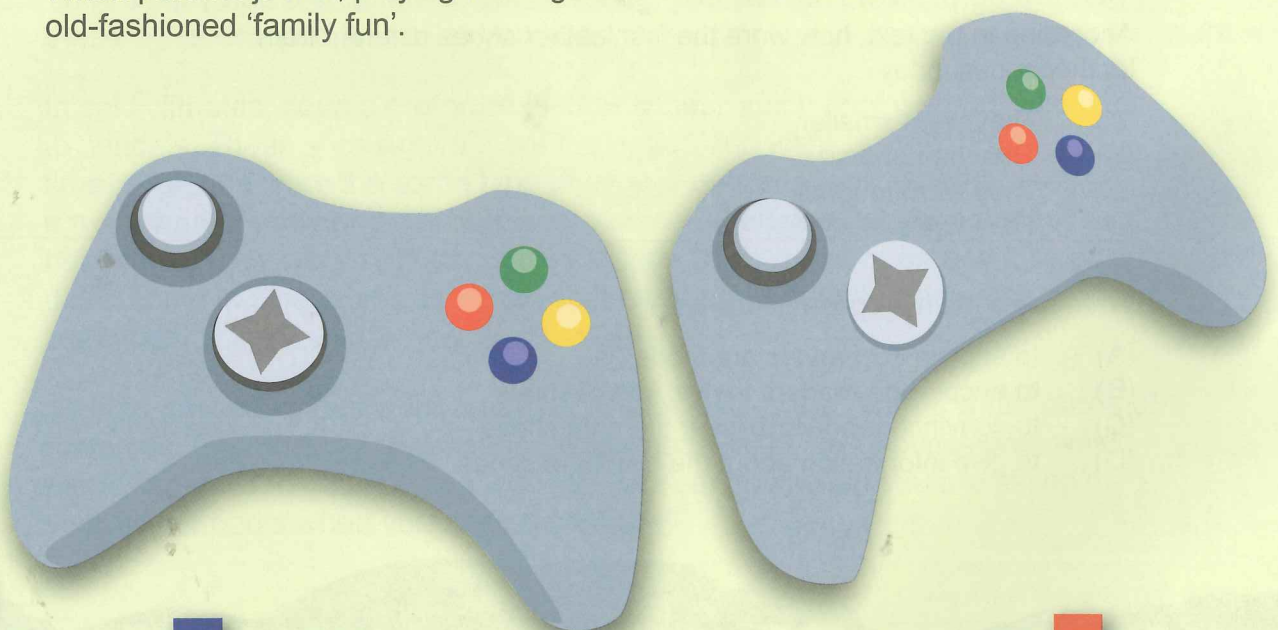
Video games require concentration and determination, patience and stamina: some games take more than 100 hours to complete! They require quick responses: shooting that monster or dodging that falling block helps to develop hand-eye coordination (fine motor skills). They also require analysis, judgement and creativity to solve problems. If video games were straightforward, they wouldn't hold the attention of children the way they do.

Critics of video games say that playing for long periods harms eyesight. While it is true that staring at a screen for long periods of time can cause 'eye strain', there is little evidence that this causes permanent damage to eyesight. Everyone should take frequent breaks from staring at any screen to minimise risks.

Critics also say that playing video games stops children from getting outdoor exercise. But is that the fault of the game, or the fault of the adult in the house for not wanting to go outside? And what about interactive games where you act out the movements?

So next time it's raining and everyone is stuck inside, get out the interactive video games ... No, not golf again, Dad! It's my turn now, Mum. Mum! MUM!

When parents join in, playing video games starts to look like old-fashioned 'family fun'.



25. 'There is more to playing video games than some people realise.'

This sentence tells readers that playing video games

- (A) is not enjoyable for some people.
- (B) is not as interesting as other games.
- (C) is not a common activity.
- (D) is not just about entertainment.

26. What does the word 'stamina' mean?

- (A) skill
- (B) courage
- (C) endurance
- (D) performance

27. Which word has the same meaning as 'straightforward'?

- (A) boring
- (B) simple
- (C) exciting
- (D) expensive

28. According to the text, the risk of developing eye problems from playing video games can be reduced by

- (A) spending time away from the screen.
- (B) wearing special glasses.
- (C) doing eye exercises.
- (D) switching to other computer activities.

29. 'No, not golf again, Dad! It's my turn now, Mum. Mum! MUM!'

This quotation reveals that the writer expects parents

- (A) to enjoy playing video games.
- (B) to nag their children into playing video games.
- (C) to play video games to please their children.
- (D) to play video games when they are bored.

30. What is the purpose of the text?

- (A) to explain how video games work
- (B) to show which video games to buy
- (C) to convince readers that video games have benefits
- (D) to encourage readers to play video games instead of exercising

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

# The last week of the holidays

'I'm so bored!' moaned Amy as she stormed into her room. 'It's too hot!' she yelled at no one in particular. There was no doubt about it; Amy was in a bad mood. She was annoyed that she was bored, annoyed that she was hot and especially annoyed that it was nobody's fault. She wanted to shout and throw things but she was too hot.

It was the last week of the school holidays and Amy felt completely alone. Her older brother Tom was camping with a friend's family. Right now he was probably swimming in wonderfully cool water or digging into a huge ice-cream sundae or having really incredible adventures that Amy would hear about when he returned. Ugh! Sarah, her sister, was chilling out with her friends at the biggest, coolest water park in the entire world.

Being the youngest in the family had some benefits, but today Amy couldn't think of a single one. Mum had sympathised, but she had emails to write and phone calls to make. What could Mum do?

Amy sulked. She lay on her bed waiting for a breeze from the open window to cool her. She didn't feel like playing a computer game or watching TV or listening to music. She didn't feel like drawing or making a model. She didn't even feel like reading a book.

Amy decided that she would simply lie still and wait for something to happen. Google might call and offer her a job? An escaped tiger might hide in her garden? A sudden snowstorm? A huge ice-cream delivery? Amy grinned to herself. She wasn't bored anymore!

When the minute hand ticked over for the twelfth time, a loud noise at the front door made Amy jump. Over the top of the long steady ringing of the doorbell, she could hear a booming voice calling her name.



31. Which quotation best explains why Amy was bored?
- (A) 'Amy felt completely alone'
  - (B) 'Amy couldn't think of a single one'
  - (C) 'Amy sulked.'
  - (D) 'Amy grinned to herself.'
32. In the second paragraph, why does Amy describe what her brother and sister were doing?
- (A) to show that she wanted to be in the coolest place
  - (B) to suggest how much she liked them
  - (C) to show that she enjoyed swimming
  - (D) to highlight how grumpy she felt
33. The questions in the fifth paragraph show that Amy was
- (A) testing her memory.
  - (B) using her imagination.
  - (C) wanting answers from someone.
  - (D) unsure about these experiences.
34. At the end of the text, Amy was interrupted by
- (A) the loud noise from the lounge room.
  - (B) the steady ringing of the alarm clock.
  - (C) the arrival of someone at the house.
  - (D) the memory of a huge ice-cream.
35. How do Amy's feelings change from the beginning to the end of the text?
- (A) irritable → contented → startled
  - (B) jealous → frustrated → tired
  - (C) frustrated → irritable → jealous
  - (D) excited → worried → sad

## Year 2- 2015 English Answer Keys

| Question Number | Answer |
|-----------------|--------|
| 1               | B      |
| 2               | D      |
| 3               | C      |
| 4               | B      |
| 5               | B      |
| 6               | C      |
| 7               | B      |
| 8               | D      |
| 9               | D      |
| 10              | C      |
| 11              | C      |
| 12              | C      |
| 13              | B      |
| 14              | D      |
| 15              | C      |
| 16              | B      |
| 17              | B      |
| 18              | A      |
| 19              | A      |
| 20              | C      |
| 21              | B      |
| 22              | D      |
| 23              | B      |
| 24              | D      |
| 25              | D      |
| 26              | A      |
| 27              | B      |
| 28              | A      |
| 29              | A      |
| 30              | C      |
| 31              | A      |
| 32              | D      |
| 33              | C      |
| 34              | C      |
| 35              | A      |